

Medication Safety: General Information

Using medicines safely

Always take medicines exactly as directed by a prescriber or the product label. Do not share prescription medicines, and do not stop or change a prescribed medicine without speaking to a healthcare professional.

Keeping a medicine list

Keep an up-to-date list of every medicine, vitamin and supplement you take and share it with your doctor and pharmacist. Some medicines interact with each other or with certain foods and alcohol.

Side effects and allergies

Read the information leaflet for possible side effects. If a severe reaction such as swelling of the face or throat, trouble breathing or a widespread rash occurs, seek emergency care immediately. Tell every provider about any known allergies.

Storage and disposal

Store medicines as the label directs, away from heat and moisture and out of reach of children. Dispose of expired or unused medicines through a pharmacy take-back program where available.

Limits of this document

This document gives general safety information only. It does not provide dosage instructions. Questions about whether to take a medicine, or how much, must be answered by a doctor or pharmacist who knows the person's situation.